

AI & Tech News Digest

Evening Edition -- Today's Top Stories

Thursday, September 24, 2026

1 Google Gemini Can Now Make Phone Calls for You

Google is rolling out an early experiment for Pixel 11 users that allows the Gemini assistant to make phone calls to local businesses on your behalf. Whether you need to make a restaurant reservation, check if a specific product is in stock, or reschedule an appointment, Gemini can handle the conversation and bypass the dreaded wait on hold. This feature bridges the gap between digital text prompts and physical-world phone interactions. It leverages advanced voice synthesis and real-time reasoning to handle unexpected dialogue from human customer service reps. Users can reclaim valuable time by delegating these routine administrative phone chores entirely to AI.

Why it matters:

Delegating real-world phone calls to AI marks a crucial evolution in consumer automation, moving software from passive information retrieval to active physical-world execution. For developers and engineers, handling asynchronous voice workflows and telephony integration will become a major design pattern.

Source: The Verge | <https://www.theverge.com/ai-artificial-intelligence/1000116/google-gemini-busine...>

2 Meta Introduces Mobile AI Tools to Build Games Instantly

Meta has announced a new suite of development tools, anchored by Horizon Create, designed to let users build games using simple AI prompts directly from their smartphones. Aimed at supercharging content creation for Meta's Horizon social platform, the tool simplifies everything from asset generation to logic setup. Instead of requiring complex game engines or coding experience, creators can type out what they want to see and experience. This push is part of Meta's broader strategy to flood its ecosystem with engaging user-generated virtual worlds and games. By lowering the barrier to entry, Meta hopes to attract a massive wave of non-technical creators.

Why it matters:

Text-to-game tools democratize digital creation, transforming anyone with a smartphone into a game designer. As these tools mature, backend infrastructure will need to handle massive spikes in automated asset rendering and real-time spatial compilation.

Source: The Verge | <https://www.theverge.com/games/999972/meta-horizon-create-studio-ai-games>

3 Tutoring Company Advises Parents to Ditch Human Tutors for AI

In a bold and unexpected industry pivot, a prominent tutoring company has publicly told parents to save their hard-earned money and use AI tools for education instead. The company recognizes that modern LLMs can deliver personalized, patient, and context-aware tutoring on demand for a fraction of the cost of traditional private lessons. Rather than fighting the technological shift, the firm is leaning into the reality that AI provides superior scalability and availability for struggling students. This announcement highlights how quickly consumer trust in generative AI for specialized education is solidifying. Traditional service models are being forced to adapt as AI proves exceptionally capable at individualized instruction.

Why it matters:

When traditional service providers start cannibalizing their own core offerings in favor of AI, it signals a structural shift in the market. Education and advisory sectors must evolve to focus on human mentorship and

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emotional intelligence rather than rote instruction.

Source: Australian Financial Review | <https://www.afr.com/policy/health-and-education/tutoring-company-tell-parents-to...>